ORACLE CLOUD

Free Tier Cloud Hosting

Step-by-step guide to signup, budget alerts, Ampere A1 instance setup, capacity errors, and Pay-As-You-Go upgrade

4 OCPUs Article target configuration	**24 GB RAM** Article target configuration	**200 GB storage** Storage limit to verify

Important: This guide retains the requested four-step procedure. Oracle's current official Always Free documentation describes the A1 allowance as 2 OCPUs and 12 GB RAM total. The 4 OCPU / 24 GB configuration may exceed Always Free limits and could incur charges. Always verify the price shown in your Oracle Console.

Prepared with official Oracle reference links only.

How to use this report

Follow the steps in order. Console labels and eligibility may change, so use the official Oracle references at the end if a menu or option looks different.

Contents

- Step 1 — Register for Oracle Cloud Free Tier
- Step 2 — Set a budget alert
- Step 3 — Create an Ampere A1 instance
- Handle “Out of capacity” errors
- Step 4 — Upgrade to Pay-As-You-Go
- Requirements and official verification

STEP 1 — Register for an Oracle Cloud Free-Tier Account

Official signup page: https://www.oracle.com/cloud/free/

- **1. Open the signup page:** Visit the Oracle Free Tier website.
- **2. Start for free:** Click “Start for Free.”
- **3. Fill in your details:** Enter your real name and email address. Do not use a fake email; Oracle may verify it.
- **4. Choose the Home Region (critical):** Select the region where your tenancy’s home-region resources will reside. The supplied instructions recommend a location close to you and mention US East Ashburn or Germany Frankfurt as examples.
- **5. Complete identity verification:** Enter your address and phone number and follow Oracle’s verification prompts.
- **6. Wait for confirmation:** Account activation timing varies; the supplied instructions estimate 15 minutes to 24 hours.

Home Region warning: The instructions say this choice cannot be changed later. Confirm the region carefully before completing signup.

STEP 2 — Set a Budget Alert

A budget alert can notify you when spending reaches a configured threshold. It is not a hard spending cap and does not prevent charges by itself.

- Sign in to the Oracle Cloud Dashboard.
- Click the “Hamburger Menu” (three lines) in the top-left corner.
- Open **Billing & Cost Management** → **Budgets**.
- Click **Create Budget**.
- Name: enter **My Safety Alarm**.
- Amount: enter **1** (intended as US$1).
- Scroll to **Budget Alert Rule**.
- Threshold: enter **100%**.
- Email: enter your email address and save.

Purpose: Receive an email alert when the configured threshold is reached. A budget alert alone is not a guarantee against charges.

STEP 3 — Create an Ampere A1 Instance

The requested target configuration is **VM.Standard.A1.Flex** with 4 OCPUs and 24 GB RAM. This is reproduced as requested, but it is not the current published Always Free A1 allowance; read the warning below before relying on it as free.

- From the dashboard, click **Create Instance**.
- Scroll to **Image and Shape**.
- Click **Change Shape**.
- Select the **Ampere** processor family.
- Choose **VM.Standard.A1.Flex**.
- The supplied instructions say to set **OCPUs = 4**.
- The supplied instructions say to set **Memory = 24 GB**.
- Click **Select Shape** and check any displayed eligibility label.
- Review the image, region, boot volume, networking and estimated cost before clicking Create.

Official limit check: Oracle’s current documentation states that Always Free A1 resources total 1,500 OCPU-hours and 9,000 GB-hours per month, equivalent to 2 OCPUs and 12 GB RAM. A 4 OCPU / 24 GB setup exceeds this allowance unless covered by other credits or paid usage. Do not assume it is free merely because the shape is selectable.

Handling “Out of capacity” errors

An error such as “Out of capacity for shape VM.Standard.A1.Flex in availability domain AD-1” can indicate a temporary shortage of capacity in the selected region or availability domain.

Method A — Try another Availability Domain

In the Placement section, try another available Availability Domain (for example, AD-1, AD-2 or AD-3 if those options exist). The available options depend on the region.

Method B — Wait and retry

Wait and try creating the instance later. The supplied instructions suggest off-peak hours such as late nights or weekends; this is not a guarantee.

Method C — Consider upgrading

The supplied instructions recommend upgrading to Pay-As-You-Go. This may provide access to more resource options, but it does not guarantee immediate capacity in a full region.

STEP 4 — Upgrade to Pay-As-You-Go

- Log in to the Oracle Cloud Console.
- Click the three-line menu in the top-left corner.
- Open **Billing & Cost Management**.
- Select **Upgrade and Manage Payment**.
- In the **Pay-As-You-Go** section, click **Upgrade**.
- Complete Oracle’s payment-method verification prompts.
- Review the terms and any verification amount shown before confirming.
- After the upgrade is complete, return to instance creation and retry.

Payment caution: The supplied instructions mention a temporary verification hold of about US$100 (or local equivalent), usually reversed in 3–5 business days. The amount and timing can vary. Check the amount shown by Oracle and your bank. Pay-As-You-Go is a paid account type; usage beyond Always Free limits can be billed.

Requirements and eligibility

Requirement	Details
Payment method	A valid credit card or supported debit/payment method may be required for verification.
Identity verification	Use real details and complete Oracle’s identity and payment checks.
Temporary transaction	The instructions mention around US$1 or US$100 depending on region. Confirm the actual amount displayed.
One account per person	Follow Oracle’s account policies; do not create multiple accounts to bypass eligibility.
Home Region	Choose carefully during signup; the instructions say it cannot be changed later.

Additional points to check

- Storage allowances count boot and block volumes together; confirm the current allowance in Oracle’s official documentation.
- Networking transfer allowances and public IP availability depend on Oracle’s current terms and your configuration.
- Do not assume a server is guaranteed to remain forever. Oracle documents conditions under which idle Always Free compute instances may be reclaimed.
- Keep backups of important data and review billing and usage regularly.

Official Oracle reference links

Use these official Oracle pages to confirm current limits, eligibility, capacity guidance and account terms.

1. Oracle Cloud Free Tier signup
https://www.oracle.com/cloud/free/

2. Oracle Always Free resources
https://docs.oracle.com/en-us/iaas/Content/FreeTier/freetier_topic-Always_Free_Resources.htm

3. Oracle Compute overview
https://docs.oracle.com/en-us/iaas/Content/Compute/Concepts/computeoverview.htm

Important verification findings

- The current published Always Free A1 allowance is 2 OCPUs and 12 GB RAM total for Always Free tenancies.
- Out-of-capacity errors may be temporary; trying another Availability Domain or waiting may help.
- Pay-As-You-Go does not mean all usage is free. Resources beyond Always Free limits can be charged.
- Budget alerts notify you but do not act as a spending lock.

Final note: This report is an instructional guide, not a guarantee of free capacity or zero billing. Before creating an instance or upgrading, rely on the prices and limits shown in your Oracle Console and Oracle's current official documentation.